Hum Nafrat Ke Bazaar Mein Mohabbat Ki Dukan

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Jawaharlal Nehru, writing from prison, in *The Discovery of India*, best summed up the liberating impact of Gandhi ji's arrival on the Indian scene in the early twentieth century, when India was suffering from tremendous colonial oppression. Many elements of a similar kind of oppression we witness again in India today. Nehru said:

> The dominant impulse in India under British rule was that of fear—pervasive, oppressing, strangling fear; fear of the army, the police, the wide spread secret service; fear of the official class; fear of laws meant to suppress and of prison; fear of the landlord's agent; fear of the money lender; fear of unemployment and starvation, which were always on the threshold.
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> And then Gandhi came … It was against this all-pervading fear that Gandhi's quiet and determined voice was raised: *Be not afraid* …
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> He was like a powerful current of fresh air that made us stretch ourselves and take deep breaths; like a beam of light that pierced the darkness and removed the scales from our eyes; like a whirlwind that upset many things, but most of all the working of people's minds.